Lesson 8 — The Line We Share

Part 3 of 12: Vocabulary and Lesson 6 recall

Level: B1 (eighth step)

About 35 minutes · this part carries a sheet and audio

2.1 Key words

#	WORD	TYPE	SIMPLE MEANING	ARABIC	EXAMPLE
1	uplink	noun	the one connection that joins a local network to the internet	الوصلة الصاعدة	Seven families, one uplink.
2	mesh	noun	a network in which every point passes the signal on to the next	شبكة متداخلة	A mesh lets a street share one line.
3	relay	verb	to pass a signal on to the next point	ينقل الإشارة	Every point relays the signal on to the next.
4	antenna	noun	the part that sends and receives a radio signal	هوائي	It goes up to an antenna on the roof.
5	signal	noun	the radio waves that carry data through the air	إشارة	There is simply no signal to pass on.
6	latency	noun	the delay between sending something and it arriving	زمن التأخير	She downloads the slides when the latency is low.
7	reliable	adjective	something you can depend on, because it works every time	موثوق	The rules are what make a shared line reliable.
8	tower	noun	a tall structure that holds an antenna up high	برج	The tower on the roof is a length of pipe.
9	neighbour	noun	a person who lives in the next house or flat	جار	A neighbour put it up in an afternoon.
10	roof	noun	the top of a building, above the highest floor	سطح البناية	There is a second antenna on the roof opposite.
11	afford	verb	to have enough money to pay for something	يستطيع تحمّل تكلفته	No single family could afford the line on its own.
12	apply	verb	to ask officially for a place, a job or money	يتقدّم بطلب	If she is not accepted, she will apply again in the spring.
13	scholarship	noun	money given to a student so that she can study	منحة دراسية	An exchange place with a small scholarship attached.
14	requirement	noun	something you must have or reach before you are allowed in	شرط	A language requirement she is four months from meeting.

2.2 Synonyms and opposites

WORD	SYNONYM	OPPOSITE
reliable	dependable, steady	unreliable
afford	be able to pay for	be too expensive for
apply	put in a request	withdraw
relay	pass on, forward	hold back
latency	delay, lag	an instant reply
requirement	condition, must-have	an option
share	use together	keep to yourself
fail	stop working	hold up

2.3 Expressions to learn

EXPRESSION	WHAT IT REALLY MEANS
hangs off it	depends completely on it
a second way in	another route to the same place when the first fails
within a minute	very quickly indeed
either way	whichever of the two things happens
plan around something	arrange everything else to fit a thing you cannot change
turn a wish into an excuse	use what you lack as a reason to stop trying
four months away from	needing four more months to reach

2.4 Vocabulary practice

A. Write the opposite:

1. reliable → _____
2. afford → _____
3. apply → _____
4. share → _____
5. latency → _____

B. Which word is different? Say why:

1. antenna — tower — roof — scholarship
2. uplink — mesh — relay — requirement
3. latency — signal — bandwidth — neighbour

C. Say it in your own words:

1. What is latency, and when do you notice it?
2. What is a requirement? Name one you are working towards.